

ALFIE BUNYAN

Games User Researcher & Behavioural Research Specialist

CONTACT

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- alfie-bunyan portfolio

EDUCATION

MSc Psychology in Game Design & Digital Innovation
University of Surrey | 2025–Present
Predicted 1st Class Honours

BSc Psychology
University of Surrey | 2022–2025
2:1

SKILLS

Research Methods
Playtesting facilitation · Semi-structured interviews · Think-aloud protocols · Thematic analysis · Eye-tracking (VR) · Behavioural observation · Participant recruitment · Within/between-subjects design · Survey & experiment design · Ethics & consent management

Analysis
Jamovi (advanced) · SPSS · Qualitative coding · Affinity mapping · Mixed-methods design · Descriptive & inferential statistics

Technical
Unreal Engine (prototyping) · VR systems · Microsoft Office Suite

Professional
Stakeholder presentation · Research documentation · Participant facilitation · Event coordination

Tools & Platforms
Qualtrics · Google Forms · MS Teams · Zoom (remote session facilitation) · OBS Studio (session recording)

Game Research
Heuristic evaluation · Player psychology frameworks · Game feel & UX critique · Playtesting documentation · Engagement & retention analysis

REFERENCES

- Gemma White**
Gemma.white@tottenhamhotspur.com
- Dr. Di Fu (Academic)**
d.fu@surrey.ac.uk

PROFILE

Postgraduate researcher specialising in user research for games and interactive systems, with direct industry experience conducting end-to-end playtests for a live studio. Skilled in mixed-methods research — combining VR-based user studies, eye-tracking, semi-structured interviews, and thematic analysis — grounded in a specialist MSc in Psychology, Game Design and Digital Innovation. Translates behavioural insight into clear, actionable design recommendations for development teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

- GAME TESTER & USER RESEARCHER** · *Academic Research Placement*
- 22cans — Masters of Albion** *Jan 2026 – Apr 2026*
- Managed the full user research lifecycle: ethics documentation, consent procedures, participant recruitment, and session facilitation for an officially released title.
 - Conducted and transcribed semi-structured post-play interviews; applied thematic analysis to surface key usability pain points and engagement patterns.
 - Compiled and presented a stakeholder-ready report to the studio, including prioritised design recommendations and identified weaknesses.

- SENIOR STUDENT AMBASSADOR**
- MySurrey Hive — University of Surrey** *Oct 2022 – Present*
- Delivered structured presentations and campus tours to audiences of 100+ per event, adapting communication style across school groups, parents, and prospective students.
 - Coordinated multi-team event logistics, maintaining smooth delivery and consistent visitor experience under time pressure.

- LOGISTICS ASSISTANT**
- Tottenham Hotspur Stadium** *Jul 2022 – Sep 2025*
- Managed resource allocation and cross-team communication for live events exceeding 50,000 attendees across 3+ years of consistent operational delivery.
 - Implemented and enforced safety protocols in high-pressure, time-critical environments, ensuring compliance across all event zones.
 - Briefed and coordinated team members on shift procedures, maintaining consistent standards across varying event formats and crowd sizes.
 - Monitored stock and equipment deployment across multiple areas, flagging and resolving shortfalls before and during live events.

SELECTED PROJECTS & AWARDS

- MSc Dissertation — Trust in Autonomous Vehicles (VR)** · *University of Surrey, 2025–Present*
Designing and conducting a VR study examining how driving style and explanatory behaviour affect user trust in autonomous systems — combining quantitative psychometrics and qualitative self-report analysis.
- VR Cognitive Impairment Simulation** · *MSc Module Project*
Prototyped an Unreal Engine VR environment simulating alcohol-like visual impairment to assess cognitive performance; delivered full findings presentation to academic audience.
- Gamified DCD Research** · *BSc Research Project*
Designed a gamified experiment measuring DCD's effect on educational engagement in children aged 9–11, using child-appropriate survey methodology and behavioural analysis.

Gen.G Practicum Scholarship
Competitive scholarship for gaming industry practicum abroad programme (Jun 2024)

PhD Research Proposal
Developed full doctoral proposal in games user research & player psychology (2026)

Limit Break Mentorship Programme
Selected applicant for games industry mentorship (2025/26)

Surrey Video Game Society
Active member · Game jam participant · AAA title design critiques